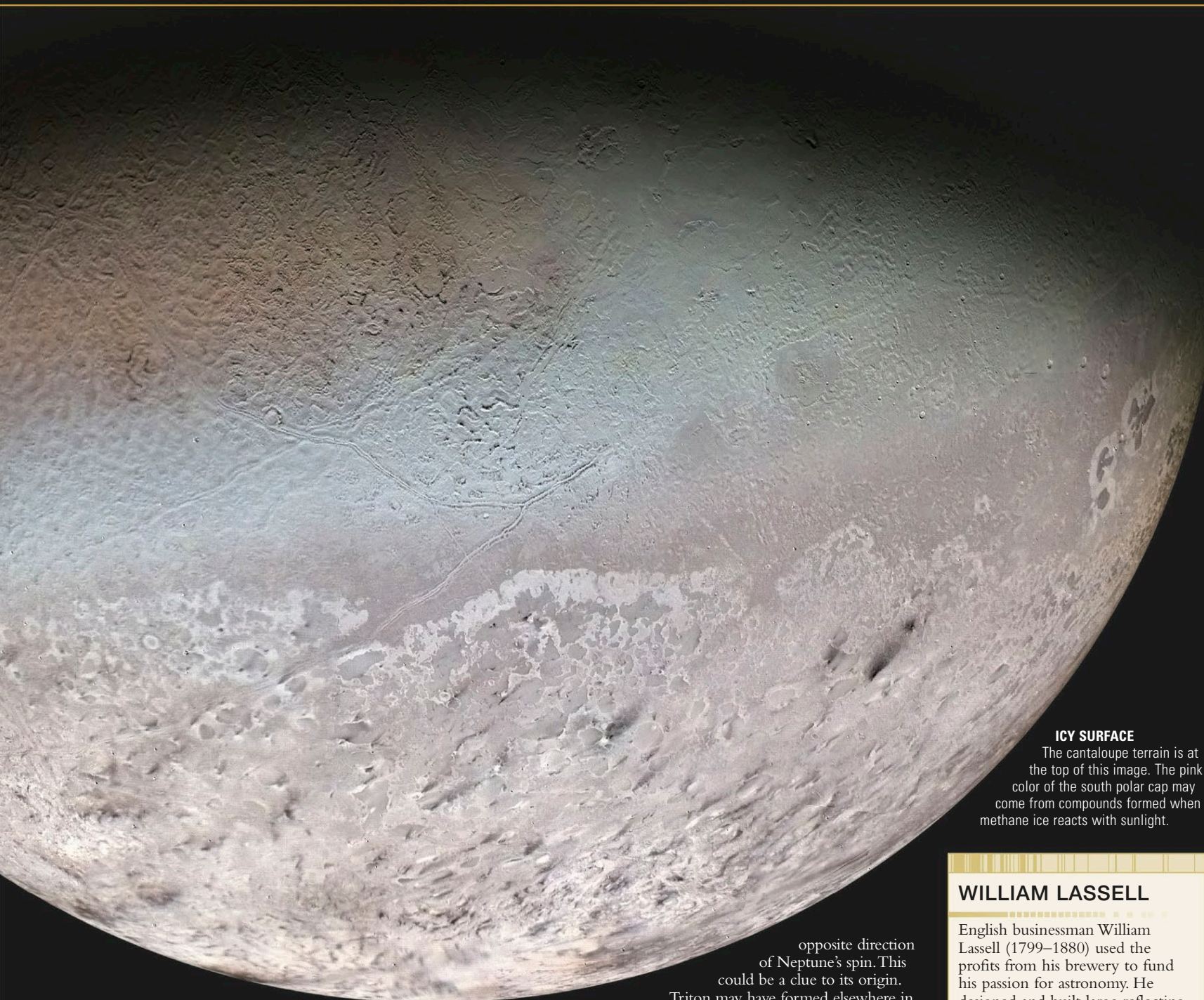


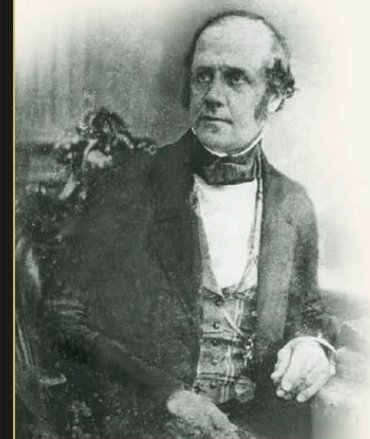


ICY SURFACE

The cantaloupe terrain is at the top of this image. The pink color of the south polar cap may come from compounds formed when methane ice reacts with sunlight.

WILLIAM LASSELL

English businessman William Lassell (1799–1880) used the profits from his brewery to fund his passion for astronomy. He designed and built large reflecting telescopes that were the finest of the day. He made his observations first from his home in Liverpool, England, then from the island of Malta. In addition to Triton, Lassell discovered the Uranian moons Ariel and Umbriel and Saturn's moon Hyperion.

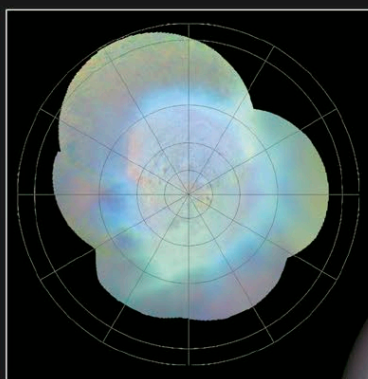


opposite direction of Neptune's spin. This could be a clue to its origin.

Triton may have formed elsewhere in the solar system and been captured by Neptune. The moon's mix of two parts rock to one part ice is differentiated into a rocky core, a possibly liquid mantle, and an ice crust. Its geologically young, icy surface has few craters and displays a range of features. An area of linear grooves, ridges, and circular depressions is nicknamed the cantaloupe after its resemblance to a melon's skin. Dark patches mark the south polar region. These form when solar heat turns subsurface nitrogen ice into gas. This erupts through surface vents in geyserlike plumes, which carry dark, possibly carbonaceous dust into the atmosphere before depositing it on Triton's surface.

SOUTHERN HEMISPHERE

Three Voyager 2 images were combined to produce this almost full-disk image of Triton. From a distance, the southern-hemisphere terrain appears mottled.



POLAR PROJECTION

Triton's south polar region is seen head-on in this image. A band of bluish material extends out from the central polar cap into the equatorial region. It is probably fresh nitrogen frost or snow redistributed by the wind.

mottled crust

